



Peter Thiel

Co-Founder & Chairman of the Board

\$4.48B (FY2025)

Revenue

Denver

HQ

01 Who You're Meeting

Peter Thiel — Co-Founder & Chairman of the Board, Palantir Technologies.

In role: Launched Palantir in 2003 and has been its chairman since inception

Today: Chairs Palantir's board and, through the company's multi-class share structure, retains voting power disproportionate to his economic stake. Not operationally involved.

One of the most consequential investors in modern technology, and Palantir's founding financier as well as its chairman. He worked as a securities lawyer at Sullivan & Cromwell, as a speechwriter for US Secretary of Education William Bennett, and as a derivatives trader at Credit Suisse, before founding Thiel Capital Management in 1996. He co-founded PayPal in 1998 with Max Levchin and Luke Nosek, led it as CEO and took it public before its \$1.5B sale to eBay in 2002. He then founded Clarium Capital, launched Palantir in 2003, and in 2005 started Founders Fund with PayPal partners Ken Howery and Luke Nosek.

Career: Co-Founder & Chairman, Palantir Technologies; Partner and co-founder, Founders Fund; Co-founder; investment committee chair, Mithril Capital; Co-founder, Valar Ventures

Education: BA and JD, Stanford University

The company: The best-capitalized, fastest-growing name in this market by far — GAAP-profitable, ~56% revenue growth, and a fast-scaling "AIP Bootcamp" go-to-market motion pulling U.S. commercial revenue up over 130% YoY.

What they sell: Four core platforms: Gotham (defense/intelligence), Foundry (commercial enterprise data integration), Apollo (deployment infrastructure) and AIP (AI Platform, launched 2023) — lets organizations deploy LLMs directly against their own operational data.

02 Where The Company Sits

Broadest platform ambition and by far the largest balance sheet in this market. Closest comparable to Sand on category ambition ("operating system" framing) but built for data/decisions generally, not physical-infrastructure control specifically.

03 Talking Points

- Chairman and financier, not an operator — Karp runs the company and Sankar owns the technology.
- His voting control is the governance fact that matters: Palantir's direction is not set by public-market pressure.
- Founders Fund and his other vehicles invest across the sector, so he sits adjacent to vendors you may also be evaluating. Worth mapping before any conversation.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- Valuation is priced for perfection — among the most expensive large-cap software multiples in the market
- Deep ties to defense/intelligence work draw recurring criticism (ACLU and others) over predictive-policing use of Gotham
- Customer lock-in risk is real: once operations run on Foundry's ontology, switching costs are very high

04 GIP Context

GIP: No named GIP portfolio company was confirmed as a Palantir customer in available sources. The sectoral overlap is real — Palantir markets Foundry/AIP explicitly for "critical infrastructure," construction (named partners McCarthy and Kiewit), and government, territory that includes GIP-style assets like airports, ports and utilities

BlackRock: Confirmed and substantial, but passive: BlackRock is one of Palantir's largest institutional shareholders, holding roughly 5.5%–8.7% of shares outstanding across recent 13G/13F filings (an ~\$19.9B position as of mid-2026, per TIKR/SEC...)

Others at Palantir Technologies: Alex Karp (Co-Founder & CEO); Stephen Cohen (Co-Founder & President); Shyam Sankar (Chief Technology Officer)

www.palantir.com · [Founders Fund profile](#) · [Palantir leadership overview](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

Public professional and company information from the research layer of the GIP vendor tracker, generated September 15, 2026. Figures are as reported by the sources listed on the vendor's white page and are not independently audited. Research goes stale — re-run before external use.